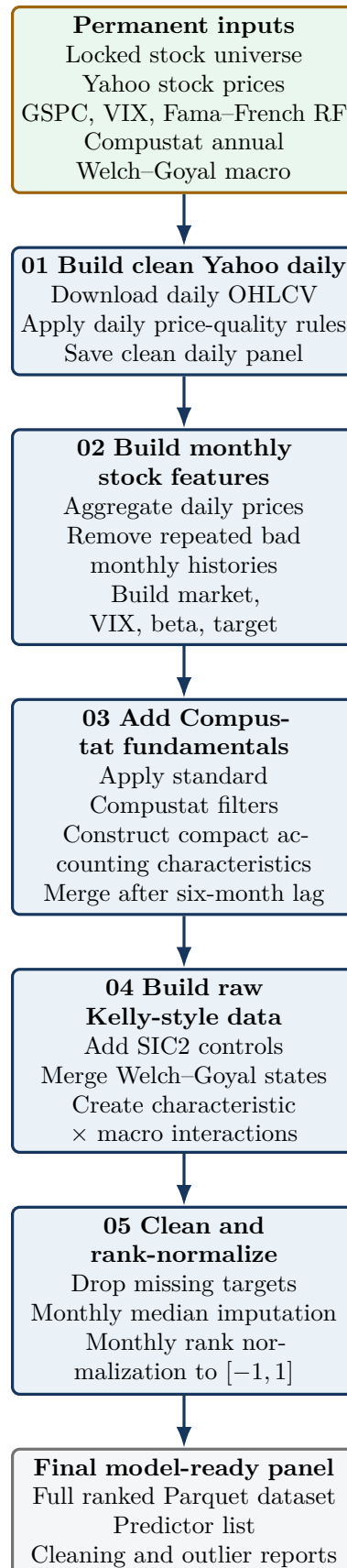


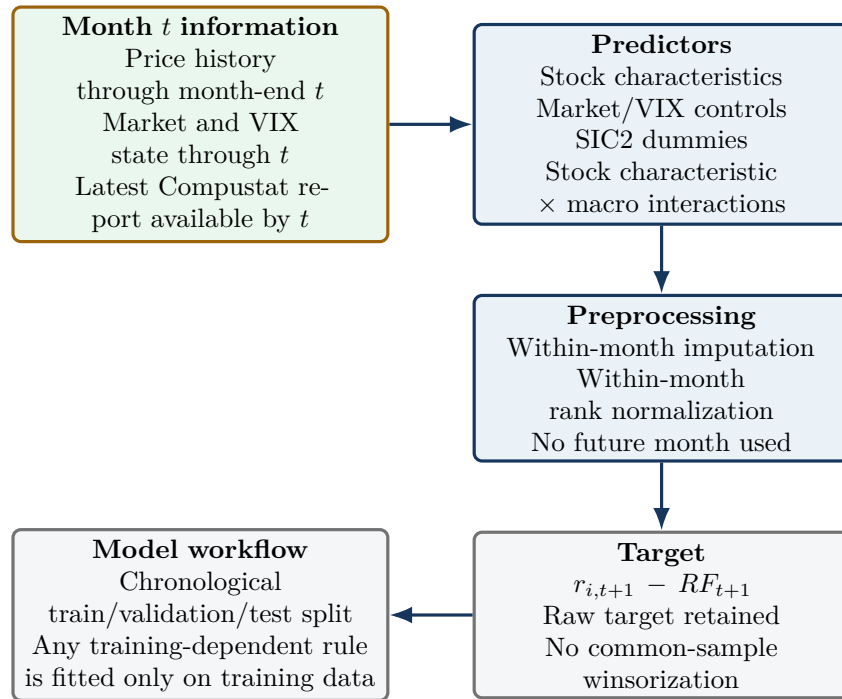
Pipeline Overview

Monthly Stock Return Prediction Data Construction

Final model sample: January 1990–December 2025



Timing and Leakage Controls



Accounting timing	Annual Compustat data are available only after a six-month reporting lag and are merged backward into each stock-month.
Target timing	A row dated month t predicts next-month excess return, $r_{i,t+1} - RF_{t+1}$.
Cross-sectional pre-processing	Imputation and rank normalization use only firms observed in the same month.
Sample endpoint	January 2026 prices may realize the December 2025 target, but final rows end at December 2025.